Pranav A

A Pranav (academic name) or Pranav Agrawal (full name), he/him or they/them

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Research interests

Inclusive AI policymaking, AI ethics, natural language processing, computer vision, human-computer interaction, participatory and community-based auditing.

Education

University of Hamburg *Hamburg, Germany*
Doctorate in Philosophy, Computer Science *Sep. 2024 – Present*

- Advisor: Prof. Anne Lauscher, Trustworthy AI Lab
- Dissertation on accountability evasion in surveillance AI and the community responses to it

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology *Hong Kong*
Master of Science in Big Data Technology *Sep. 2017 – Sep. 2018*

- Entrance scholarship for top performance; graduated in the top 10 percent of the class

VIT University *Vellore, India*
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering *Sep. 2013 – Sep. 2017*

- Top 10 percent of the class; best undergraduate thesis award
- Thesis: Exploration of Heuristics in IR in Applications of Approximate String Similarity

Experience

Machine Learning Lead *Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2024*
Dayta AI *Hong Kong*

- Led computer vision and NLP for Cyclops, a cloud shopper analytics product that reports visitor demographics, dwell time, and engagement, processing over 150,000 videos a day for retail, mall, and exhibition clients
- Built the Traditional Chinese language stack behind customer-facing text: question answering over Chinese corpora, news paraphrasing, and Simplified to Traditional script conversion

Publications

C: conference. W: workshop. P: preprint or under submission. * denotes equal contribution.

C.13 Training on Mass Surveillance Datasets Provides No Empirical Benefits
A Pranav, Anne Lauscher
AIES 2026

C.12 Auditing AI-Washing in German Startups: A Mixed-Methods Study of Marketing Claims and Perceptions
A Pranav, Luke Hartmann, Anne Lauscher
AIES 2026

C.11 Resisting Surveillance AI: Mechanisms of Accountability Evasion and Community Engagement
A Pranav
AIES 2026

P.10 Epistemic Injustice in Language Models: An Audit of Pretraining Filters and Guardrails
Marco Antonio Stranisci*, **A Pranav***, Rossana Damiano, Christian Hardmeier, Anne Lauscher
arXiv 2026 [arXiv]

C.9 The Double Bind: Revisiting Preprinting and Peer Review Two Years After the Removal of the ACL Anonymity Period
A Pranav, Shane Storks, Anne Lauscher
ACL 2026 (Findings) [ACL Anthology]

C.8 Making a Name for Myself: On Academic Naming Policies and their Impact
A Pranav, Vagrant Gautam, Martin Mundt, Jordan Taylor, Arjun Subramonian, Franziska Sofia Hafner, Daniel Chechelnitsky, William Agnew, Anne Lauscher
FAccT 2026 Best Paper Award, Honourable Mention. [arXiv]

W.7 Queering the Audits: Community-Based Auditing of AI Harms to Queer Communities
Organizers of Queer in AI, **A Pranav**, Alissa A. Valentine, Alex Markham, Beckett LeClair, Tereza Blazkova, Ekaterina Kornilitsina, Sofie H. Bruun, Gerasimos Spanakis, Anne Lauscher
LREC 2026 Workshop on Identity-Aware AI (IAAI) [PDF]

C.6 Glitter: A Multi-Sentence, Multi-Reference Benchmark for Gender-Fair German Machine Translation
A Pranav, Janiča Hackenbuchner, Giuseppe Attanasio, Manuel Lardelli, Anne Lauscher
EMNLP 2025 (Findings) [ACL Anthology]

P.5 The Cake that is Intelligence and Who Gets to Bake it: An AI Analogy and its Implications for Participation
Martin Mundt, Anaelia Ovalle, Felix Friedrich, **A Pranav**, Subarnaduti Paul, Manuel Brack, Kristian Kersting, William Agnew
arXiv 2025 [arXiv]

C.4 Comparing Static and Contextual Distributional Semantic Models on Intrinsic Tasks: An Evaluation on Mandarin Chinese Datasets
A Pranav, Yan Cong, Emmanuele Chersoni, Yu-Yin Hsu, Alessandro Lenci
LREC-COLING 2024 [ACL Anthology]

C.3 Queer in AI: A Case Study in Community-Led Participatory AI
Organizers of Queer in AI, including **A Pranav**
FAccT 2023 Best Paper Award. [arXiv]

C.2 2kenize: Tying Subword Sequences for Chinese Script Conversion
A Pranav, Isabelle Augenstein
ACL 2020 (Main) [arXiv] [code]

W.1 Alignment Analysis of Sequential Segmentation of Lexicons to Improve Automatic Cognate Detection
A Pranav
ACL 2018 Student Research Workshop [ACL Anthology] [code]

Talks and Presentations

Glitter: A Multi-Sentence, Multi-Reference Benchmark for Gender-Fair German Machine Translation *2026*
KONVENS, Poster Session

Making a Name for Myself: On Academic Naming Policies and their Impact *2026*
IJCAI, D&I Session

Building Inclusive Policies in Academia *2025*
EurIPS, Queer in AI workshop

Refcheck: Checking for Correct Cites in Publishing *2025*
NeurIPS, Queer in AI workshop

Policy Impact: From AI Regulation to Academic Inclusion *2025*
Saarland University

Policy Impact: From AI Regulation to Academic Inclusion *2025*
University of Bremen

Trans-Inclusive Publishing Advocacy *2024*
Uppsala University

Making Conferences Queer Friendly *2021*
Widening NLP

2kenize: Tying Subword Sequences for Chinese Script Conversion *2020*
Hong Kong Machine Learning Meetup

Learn Languages First and Then Convert: Towards Effective Simplified to Traditional Chinese Conversion *2019*
NAACL Student Research Workshop

Teaching

Course tutor and lecturer

University of Hamburg *Winter 2024 – Present*

- Multilingual, Multimodal and Multicultural AI (Winter 2026)
- Trustworthy AI (Summer 2026)
- Text Analysis, NLP (Winter 2025)
- Ethics in Modern AI (Summer 2025)
- Data Science in Practice (Summer 2025)
- Text Analysis, NLP (Winter 2024)

Mentor and thesis supervisor

- Luke Hartmann
- Aaron Gresser,
- Jansen Tjia
- Simon Laatz
- Fynn Wyroslawski
- Nico Hertle

Non-academic teaching

- Co-leads Tupananchiskamas, the improv comedy group at the University of Hamburg
- Teaches Insight Dialogue, a meditation practice that brings mindfulness into conversation

Service and D&I advocacy

Reviewer

- Conferences: KONVENS 2026, AIES 2026, EMNLP 2026, ACL 2026, EMNLP 2025, EMNLP 2024, LREC 2024
- Workshops: IAAI 2026, IAAI 2025, ACL Student Research Workshop 2020, Queer in AI workshops (2019 to 2026)

Workshop organizer

- Contemplating the Future of Queer AI, IJCAI-ECAI 2026, University of Bremen
- Identity-Aware AI (IAAI), 2026 and 2025
- Queer in AI workshops: NeurIPS 2026, EurIPS 2025, ACL 2025

Event organizer

- Queer in AI socials: AIES 2026, and socials at *CL and machine learning conferences since 2019
- Affinity group coordination at NAACL 2021, including Black in AI, Queer in AI, Masakhane, and North Africans in NLP

D&I coordinator

- Equal Opportunities team, University of Hamburg
- D&I chair, NAACL 2022

- D&I chair, NAACL 2021, building the programme on financial access, affinity group socials, research forums, and accessibility
- Co-founder, Queer in NLP, and core organizer, Queer in AI, since 2020

Awards

- Best Paper Award, Honourable Mention, FAccT, 2026
- Best Paper Award, FAccT, 2023, for Queer in AI: A Case Study in Community-Led Participatory AI
- Research presentation scholarships: ACL 2020, NAACL 2019, ACL 2018 (with travel grant)
- Entrance Scholarship, HKUST, 2017, for outstanding academic performance
- Best undergraduate thesis award, VIT University, 2017

Skills

Proficient: Python, PyTorch, LaTeX, Bash, Git, AWS, GCP

Familiar: R, TensorFlow, MySQL, C++, PySpark, Tableau, d3.js